MAHJ

Posting Guide — Step-by-step instructions

`https://web-nine-nu-qqd4wog6yi.vercel.app`

MAHJ Posting Guide

Exact step-by-step instructions for posting MAHJ to each platform. Use this alongside `LAUNCH_POSTS.md` (the content) and `LAUNCH_POSTS.pdf` (printable version).

Before You Start

Have these ready in a notes app on your phone or in a text file on your computer:

1. Your **current live URL**: `https://web-nine-nu-qqd4wog6yi.vercel.app` (update to `https://welcome2mahj.com` once DNS resolves)
2. The **contact email**: `info@welcome2mahj.com`
3. **Screenshots**: They're at `/Users/sunshinesara55/Desktop/MAHJ/web/screenshots/` (6 images at 1290x2796)
4. **The post content** from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md` — open it in a text editor so you can copy/paste

Accounts you'll need:

- Reddit (free to create at reddit.com)
- Facebook (you probably already have one)
- Twitter/X (optional)
- LinkedIn (optional)
- Instagram (optional)
- Nextdoor (optional — only if you use it)

General rules:

- **Don't post everything in one day.** Spread it out over 1-2 weeks so algorithms don't flag you as spam.
- **Reply to EVERY comment you get** within 24 hours. Engagement drives reach.
- **Don't apologize** for promoting your work. You built something useful.

PRIORITY 1: Email to Friends & Family (Do This First)

Why first: Your closest people give you the honest feedback you need before going public. They'll also share it organically.

Steps:

1. **Open your email** (Gmail, Apple Mail, whatever you use)
2. Make a list of **5-10 people** who fit ANY of these:

- Someone who plays or used to play mahj
- Someone who wanted to learn
- A family member who might share with friends
- A friend who's good at giving honest feedback

1. **Send individual emails**, not a mass email. Copy the "Email to Friends / Family" template from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`.
2. **Personalize each one**:

- Replace `[name]` with their actual name
- Add one personal sentence at the top like "Hope the trip to Florida was fun!" or "How's your mom doing?"
- Pick the opening that fits: if they play mahj, use "Remember how overwhelming mahj was when you first tried it?" If they don't, use "I know you've wanted to learn American Mahjong..."

1. **Ask explicitly for feedback.** "If you try it, I'd love to hear what you think — especially anything confusing or unclear."
2. **Hit send.**

After sending:

- Wait 2-3 days

- If people respond with feedback, thank them and fix what you can
- If people reply asking questions, answer them patiently — they're your future evangelists

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PRIORITY 2: Facebook Groups (Highest-Value Community)

Why Facebook: This is where your target audience actually hangs out. Mahj Facebook groups have thousands of active players who help beginners.

Step 1: Find the right groups

1. Open **Facebook** (facebook.com or the app)
2. In the search bar at the top, type each of these and look for groups:

- `american mahjong`
- `mah jongg`
- `NMJL mah jongg`
- `mahjongg beginners`
- `[your city] mahjong`

1. For each promising group, click to join. You may need to answer a few questions to be accepted (just say you're a learner or new player — true!)
2. **Wait for acceptance.** Some groups take a few hours to a few days to approve you.

Step 2: Read the rules FIRST

Every group has rules. MANY ban self-promotion. Here's how to check:

1. Open the group
2. Look for **"About"** or **"Group Rules"** in the left sidebar (desktop) or below the group header (mobile)
3. Look for rules like:

- "No self-promotion"
- "No promoting products"
- "Posts must be approved by admins"

1. **If self-promotion is banned:** DON'T POST. Instead, look for existing threads asking "How did you learn?" or "Any tips for beginners?" and comment there with a helpful reply that mentions MAHJ as a resource (this is usually okay even in restrictive groups).

2. **If promotion is allowed:** Proceed to Step 3.

Step 3: Post (in groups that allow it)

1. Click **"Write something..."** or **"Create Post"** at the top of the group feed
2. Copy the **"Longer version"** of the Facebook post from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`
3. Paste it into the post box
4. **Add an image or two**: Click the photo icon and upload 1-2 screenshots from your Desktop. Good ones to use:

- `01-homepage.png` (shows the module list)
- `05-cheat-sheet.png` (people love printables)

1. **Edit the URL**: Make sure the link is the one Facebook preview-cards correctly
2. Click **Post**

Step 4: Engage

- **Check back every few hours for the first day**
- **Reply to EVERY comment**, even "cool!"
- If someone asks a question, answer it warmly and specifically
- If someone says "I tried it and got confused" — thank them profusely and ask follow-up questions

After you post in one group:

- **Wait 2-3 days** before posting in the next group
- **Vary the post text slightly** — don't copy-paste identical posts across groups (Facebook's algorithm flags this as spam)

PRIORITY 3: Reddit — r/Mahjong

Why Reddit: Mahj players on Reddit are more willing to give detailed critical feedback than Facebook groups. You'll learn a lot.

Step 1: Create/check your account

1. Go to **https://www.reddit.com**

2. Click **"Log In"** or **"Sign Up"** in the top right
3. If new: create an account. **Important**: spend a few days commenting on other posts BEFORE posting your own. Reddit auto-removes posts from brand-new accounts with zero "karma" (Reddit's reputation score).
4. **Build karma by:**

- Commenting helpful things on 5-10 existing posts in r/Mahjong and r/mahjongsolitaire
- Upvoting posts you like
- Maybe posting a simple question like "Has anyone tried [xyz]?" to get comfortable

Step 2: Post to r/Mahjong

1. Go to **https://www.reddit.com/r/Mahjong/**
2. Click **"Create Post"** (usually at the top of the feed, might say "Text Post")
3. **Title**: Copy one of the title options from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`. My pick: "*I was so lost at my first mahj game. So I built the app I wish I'd had.*"
4. **Body**: Copy the full Reddit body text from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`
5. **Check any flair options**: If the subreddit requires post "flair" (tags), pick something like "Showcase", "Resource", or "Discussion"
6. **Don't add images on the first post** — Reddit prefers text-first on r/Mahjong. You can link to images if people ask.
7. Click **Post**

Step 3: Monitor for 24-48 hours

- **Check Reddit every few hours**
- **Reply to every comment**, even just "Thank you!"
- **Be humble**. Reddit hates self-promotion that feels arrogant.
- If someone points out a bug, **thank them specifically** and say "fixing this — thank you for catching it"
- If someone is skeptical or harsh, **don't argue**. Respond with "That's a fair point — let me think about that."

Expected outcomes:

- **First hour**: Crickets. This is normal.
- **First day**: If it's good content, 5-30 upvotes and a few comments
- **Best case**: 50+ upvotes, 10+ comments, people sharing it elsewhere

- **Worst case**: Mods remove it. If this happens, message the mods politely asking why. Sometimes you can repost with adjustments.

Step 4: Other mahj subreddits to try (AFTER r/Mahjong does well)

Wait 3-4 days after r/Mahjong, then try these if they exist and fit:

- r/boardgames (only if you have a unique angle to pitch)
- r/learnsomething (educational tool angle)
- Local city subreddits if you have a local angle

PRIORITY 4: Nextdoor (Local Community)

Why Nextdoor: Mahj is huge in 55+ communities, and Nextdoor has lots of older neighbors. Very targeted.

Steps:

1. Open **Nextdoor** (nextdoor.com or the app)
2. Go to **"Post"** or **"Create Post"**
3. Choose post type: **"General"** or **"Events & Services"** (not "For Sale")
4. Copy the Nextdoor template from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`
5. **Add a screenshot**: `01-homepage.png` or `05-cheat-sheet.png`
6. **Choose visibility**: Post to your neighborhood + nearby neighborhoods (more reach)
7. Click **Post**

Engage:

- Reply to neighbors who comment
- If someone says "my mom would love this!" — thank them and ask them to share
- Don't post again in Nextdoor for at least 2 weeks

PRIORITY 5: Twitter / X (Optional)

Why Twitter: Less targeted, but has some mahj niche presence. Good for quick shares and ongoing updates.

Steps:

1. Go to **https://twitter.com** or **https://x.com**
2. Log in (create an account if needed — use @mahjlearn or similar, since welcome2mahj might be taken)
3. Click **"Post"** or the feather/pencil icon
4. Copy **Post 1** (the hook) from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`
5. Attach **1 screenshot** — `01-homepage.png` works well
6. Click **Post**

Make it a thread:

1. Immediately after posting the first tweet, click the **"+"** button on it to add another tweet
2. Copy **Post 2** (the problem)
3. Post that as a reply to your first tweet
4. Do the same for Post 3 (cheat sheet) and Post 4 (practice game)
5. Each becomes a reply in the thread

After posting:

- **Pin the thread** to the top of your profile (click the "..." menu → Pin to Profile)
- Reply to anyone asking about mahj in general and mention MAHJ helpfully
- Post 1 new update per week (new feature, a testimonial, a tip)

PRIORITY 6: Instagram (Optional — Good for Visuals)

Why Instagram: Mahj has a surprisingly strong Instagram presence (look up #mahjonglife). Visual platform, so good screenshots matter.

Steps:

1. Open **Instagram** (app on phone is easiest)
2. Tap the **"+"** at the bottom to create a post

3. Select **"Post"** (not Story or Reel yet)
4. Pick **1-4 screenshots** from your Desktop. Best combinations:

- `01-homepage.png` + `02-tile-trainer.png` + `05-cheat-sheet.png`
- Or all 6 if you want to show everything

1. **Don't add filters** — let the app UI be the visual
2. **Caption**: Copy the Instagram caption from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`
3. **Update "link in bio"**: Instagram doesn't allow clickable links in captions. Go to your profile → Edit Profile → Website field → paste your URL
4. Tap **Share**

Follow-up:

- Reply to every comment
- Check your "link in bio" actually works
- Post 1-2 follow-up posts per week (a new feature highlight, a user testimonial if you get one)

PRIORITY 7: LinkedIn (Optional — Professional Angle)

Why LinkedIn: Reaches a different audience — developers, product people, entrepreneurs who might share it with their mahj-playing parents/friends.

Steps:

1. Go to **https://linkedin.com**
2. Click **"Start a post"** at the top of the feed
3. Copy the LinkedIn content from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`
4. **Add 1-2 screenshots**: Homepage + practice game are best here
5. **Add hashtags at the end**: #ReactJS #NextJS #BeginnerFriendly #IndieHacker #EducationalTech #Mahjong
6. Click **Post**

Follow-up:

- Reply to any comments
- If former colleagues react, thank them personally

- Consider posting a follow-up a week later about "lessons learned building MAHJ"

PRIORITY 8: Mahj Club / Teacher Outreach (High Value)

Why this: Experienced teachers can become evangelists to dozens of students each. Highest ROI for the time spent.

Step 1: Find teachers

1. Google search:

- `american mahjong teacher near me`
- `mah jongg lessons [your city]`
- `mah jongg instructor`

1. Look for:

- Mahj clubs with websites
- Individual teachers who have blogs or social presence
- Community centers offering mahj classes

1. **Collect 10-20 email addresses**

Step 2: Send personalized emails

1. Open your email and compose
2. Copy the **"Mahj Club / Teacher Outreach"** template from `LAUNCH_POSTS.md`
3. **Personalize the greeting**:

- "Hello [Teacher's Name]," (look up their actual name)
- Add one sentence referencing something specific about them: "I saw your recent article on the Charleston..." or "I noticed you teach beginner classes at the JCC..."

1. **Don't mass-send.** Send 3-5 per day at most. These are quality contacts.
2. **Subject line**: Keep the one in the template — it's clear and not spammy

Step 3: Follow up

- If someone replies positively, THANK THEM and offer to answer any questions
- If someone offers feedback, take notes carefully

- If they mention sharing it with students, ask: "Would it be okay if I mentioned your endorsement on the site?"
- Don't follow up more than once if you don't hear back — respect their time

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Posting Schedule (Recommended)

Spread this over 2 weeks. Don't rush.

Week 1:

- **Day 1**: Email to friends & family
- **Day 2**: Post in 1 Facebook mahj group
- **Day 3**: Wait. Reply to comments.
- **Day 4**: Reddit r/Mahjong post
- **Day 5**: Wait. Reply to comments.
- **Day 6**: Nextdoor post
- **Day 7**: Email 5 mahj teachers/clubs

Week 2:

- **Day 8**: Post in second Facebook group (different text)
- **Day 9**: Twitter thread
- **Day 10**: Instagram post
- **Day 11**: LinkedIn post (if you use it)
- **Day 12**: Email another 5 teachers
- **Day 13**: Post in third Facebook group
- **Day 14**: Review feedback, plan improvements

What to Track

Keep a simple spreadsheet or notes doc with:

Date	Platform	Post link	Feedback/Comments	Actions to take
2026-04-11	Email — Sarah	(n/a)	Loved the cheat sheet	Thank her
2026-04-12	Facebook — "NMJL Beginners"	[link]	12 likes, 3 comments, 1 bug report	Fix discard bug

Why this matters:

- Tracks what's working
- Gives you a list of people to thank later
- Captures feedback for future improvements
- Helps you decide where to post more or less

Common Questions You'll Get

Be ready with short answers:

"Is this affiliated with NMJL?" → "No, it's independent. I built it as a learning tool. You still need the real NMJL card to play official games."

"Do I need to pay for this?" → (Depending on your monetization choice — for now): "The web version is free to try. I'm planning an iOS app at some point."

"Why not just use the NMJL card directly?" → "The card is required for real play, but it doesn't teach you HOW to use it. MAHJ fills that gap."

"Does this work on iPad/iPhone?" → "Yes! Open the URL in Safari, then tap Share → Add to Home Screen. It'll work like an app."

"How do I give feedback?" → "Email info@welcome2mahj.com or reply here — I read everything."

"Are you copying the NMJL card?" → "No, never. The practice hands in MAHJ are original patterns that represent the CATEGORIES on the real card (2468, Consecutive Run, etc.). All examples are original for educational use."

If Something Goes Wrong

A post gets removed: Politely message the mods asking why. Usually you can adjust and repost.

Someone is harsh in the comments: Don't argue. Respond with "That's a fair point — thank you for the feedback." Never get defensive.

Someone finds a bug: THANK THEM profusely, ask for steps to reproduce, fix it as soon as you can, then reply back saying "Fixed! Thanks again for catching this."

You get overwhelmed by replies: Prioritize:

1. Bug reports (highest priority)
2. Genuine questions
3. Compliments (last — a simple thanks is fine)

Nobody responds: That's okay. Not every post lands. Move to the next platform.

After Your First Week

1. **Review feedback** — what did people say? What confused them?
2. **Fix 1-2 things** based on what you heard
3. **Post an update** on the same platforms: "Thanks for the feedback everyone — I fixed [X] and added [Y]"
4. **Celebrate** — you launched something. That's huge.